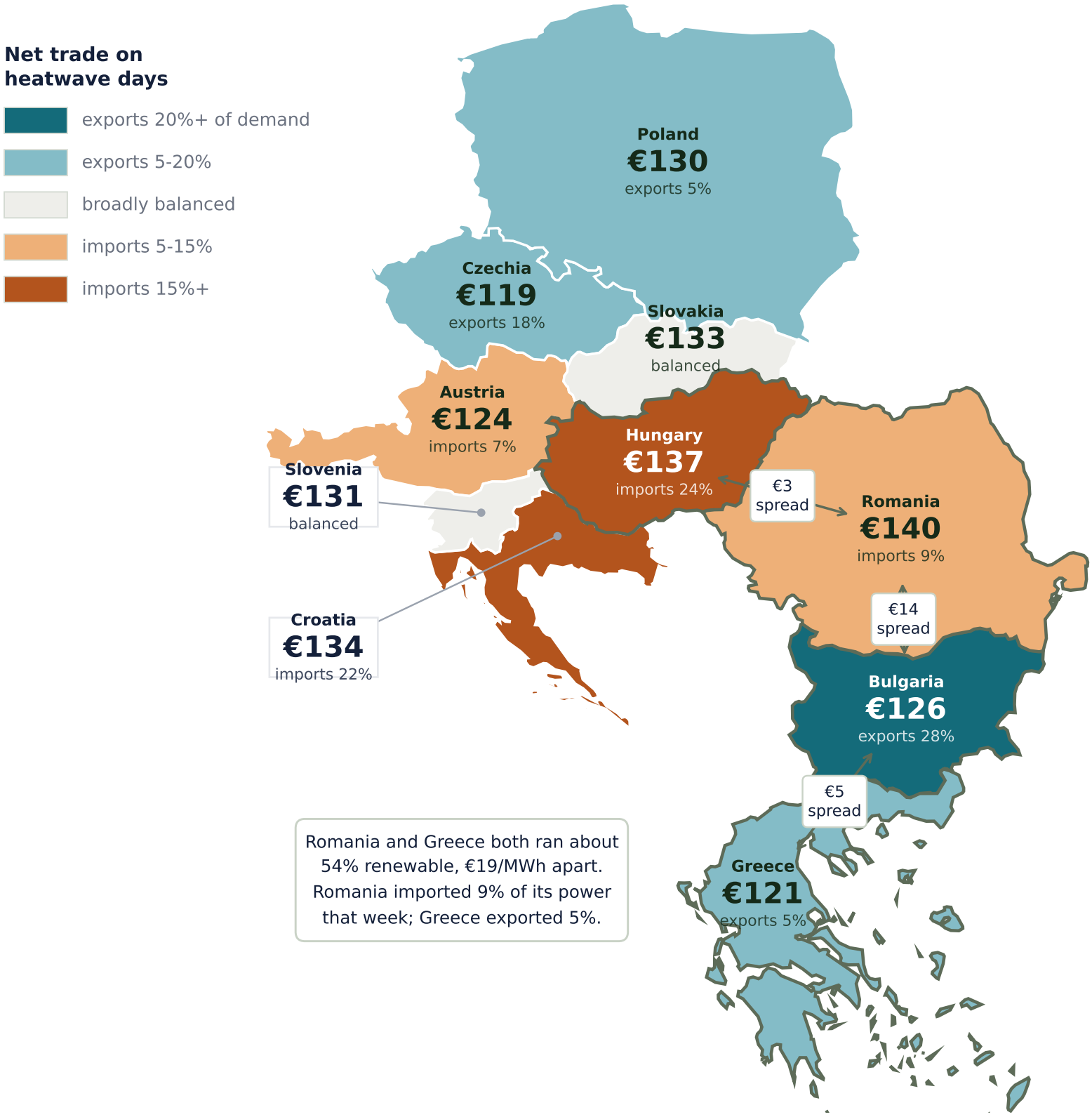
The importers paid the most, the exporters paid the least

Net trade position and average day-ahead price on heatwave days, May–September 2026. Across these ten, price tracks net trade (r = +0.67) and not renewable share (r = +0.03). Neither causes the other: a country imports because it is short, and being short is what costs. The Hungary–Romania–Bulgaria–Greece corridor spans €19/MWh.



Net trade is the balance of physical cross-border flows over the country's own demand, so a net importer is shaded warm and a net exporter cool. All of each country's interconnectors are included, the Balkan and non-EU borders among them. A heatwave day is 3+ consecutive days above the local day-of-year 90th percentile of daily maximum temperature, or at or above 30 ·C; each country is measured against its own non-heatwave days in the same May–September season, weekdays matched to weekdays. Price is the unweighted daily mean of day-ahead prices. Source: ENTSO-E Transparency Platform; ERA5 via Open-Meteo.